

Built by the room

This version puts the content first. What SLS actually achieved in 2026, told by the members who achieved it, and the people who made it possible named in front of everyone. The experience exists to carry that — not the other way around.

PROPOSED DATE	TIME	VENUE	ROOM	NOT THIS YEAR
Saturday, December 12, 2026	6:30–10:30 p.m., four hours	City Hub	300 — venue capacity	No graduation segment

Show the year. Name the people who made it.

The Assembly is the one evening the whole society is in a single room. Two things need that room: the year’s achievements, set out properly, and the partners, Council members, Chapter teams and contributors who delivered them, recognized in front of everyone. Everything else is in service of those two.

The organizing line is **built by the room** — every achievement shown traces back to someone sitting in it, and next year’s will too. It doubles as the test for the agenda: if a segment doesn’t connect to somebody present, it comes out.

RAISED	CHANGED
Could Hena hold 400 comfortably?	Venue moved to City Hub , sized for 300 across stage, seating and networking areas.
Why 400?	300 , set by the venue and by a realistic turnout on a full-membership invitation — see Format.
Is 140 minutes of floor time enough?	Fewer activities, not more time. The market, peer tables and the commitment board are cut. Floor time is now arrival, one break and dinner.
Why November?	Moved to December 12 — a year-end assembly should sit at the year’s end.
Which 2026 achievements?	Now the spine of the evening , with a collection request that has to start this month — see Content.
Over-engineered	The network graph, live voting, the introduction ledger and the personal cards are out. One screen in the arrival gallery remains, as a tool, not a concept.

The brief every segment is tested against

Before deciding what happens on stage, it is worth being exact about what we want in a member’s head on the drive home. This is the design brief; anything that doesn’t serve it comes off the agenda.

THINKING

I can name three things this society delivered in 2026.

What I contributed was seen — by name, in front of everyone.

I know what 2027 asks of me, and it is specific.

FEELING

Proud of the company I am in. Not flattered — proud.

Known. Someone in that room knows my name and what I worked on.

Impatient to start. Next year sounds worth being part of.

DOING, WITHIN A WEEK

Repeats one SLS achievement to someone outside the room.

Says yes to one named thing for 2027.

03

Key messages

Three things the evening has to land

1 **SLS is a working network, not a membership list.**

The proof is the year's achievements, and every one of them has a member's name on it.

2 **The society sees who does the work.**

Contribution is recognized publicly and specifically, not thanked in the abstract.

3 **2027 asks something of you by name.**

Not "get involved" — a defined commitment, made before members leave.

04

The content

The year's achievements, at two depths

This is the part that has to be strongest, and the part that does not exist yet. No one has assembled what SLS delivered in 2026 in one place. Doing that is the first task, and everything on stage depends on it.

The gallery, at the entrance. The full year laid out to walk through during the first fifty minutes — every chapter, every initiative, every number. Members browse at their own pace and find their own work. This is where volume lives.

Three stories, on stage. Twenty-five minutes, three members telling what happened to them rather than a milestone review read from a deck. The test for choosing them:

- A **member** did it, not the Foundation on their behalf.

- The outcome fits in **one sentence with a number in it.**
- It **would not have happened** without the society.

What we collect, and from whom. One request, one deadline, four categories — and the same request produces the recognition citations, so Chapters and the Council are asked once rather than twice:

What members built — initiatives and cross-sector projects launched this year.

What Chapters delivered — sessions held, members engaged, what came out of them.

How the society grew — new members from the Fellowship and 2030 Leaders cohorts, new chapters, international reach.

Where SLS showed up — partnerships, visits, contributions to national programs.

This is the critical path. Nothing on stage can be written until the achievements are in. The request goes to Chapter leads and the Council this month, due with the planning phase on **November 19.**

05

Recognition

Three volumes, because sixty names is not a ceremony

Partners, Council, Chapter teams and contributors together are likely sixty-plus names. A queue of sixty walks to a stage would consume most of the evening and land on the item the 2024 survey scored lowest. So recognition runs at three volumes instead.

The Wall of the Year

EVERYONE · AT THE ENTRANCE, ALL EVENING

Every partner, Council member, Chapter team and contributor named, grouped by what they did rather than by rank, alongside the gallery. Sixty names honored in the time it takes to walk in, and members find their own before anyone speaks.

Two moments on stage

FOUR GROUPS · 8:05 AND 9:25

Partners and Chapter teams before the break; the Council and the honor after the keynote. Chapter teams go up as *teams* — six people together for ninety seconds beats six separate walks. Each named recognition carries **one specific line**: what they did and what it produced. “Thank you for your support” is worth nothing to an executive.

One honor, nominated by members

ONE · 9:25

Nominations collected on the RSVP form four weeks out. In a peer society the room’s choice carries more weight than a committee’s, and it costs one extra field on a form we are already sending.

The letter home. A letter from SLS leadership to the board or CEO of each honored contributor’s organization. Recognition that reaches an executive’s employer outlives anything they can put on a shelf. It costs a signature.

06

Format and
program

Four hours, five things

WHEN	Saturday, December 12, 2026, 6:30–10:30 p.m. December puts the assembly at the year’s end, which is what a year in review needs, and leaves the production window clear of Ramadan
WHERE	City Hub — site survey still needed to confirm the layout works for a stage, seated audience, gallery and dinner in one evening
HOW MANY	300. The venue sets the ceiling. It also matches a realistic turnout: in 2024, 320 of 468 registrants attended, a 68% show rate. Inviting the full membership and planning for 300 in the room is the honest version of that arithmetic — with an RSVP cap and a waitlist rather than a number we hope to hit
BALANCE	120 minutes on stage, 120 on the floor. The longest seated stretch is 70 minutes, because in 2024 half the audience left after a long one
PRAYER	Isha (≈6:40 p.m.) falls inside the arrival window, so the program never stops for it

240 MINUTES · 120 ON STAGE

TIME SEGMENT

6:30 p.m. · 50’ **Arrival, the gallery and the Wall**
The year laid out to walk through, every contributor named on the Wall, and one screen showing the shape of the society. Isha sits inside this window.

FLOOR
RECOGNITION

TIME	SEGMENT	
7:20 · 20'	Opening: the year, and what it means The Council chair sets out the three key messages and the headline of the year.	STAGE
7:40 · 25'	Three stories from the year Three members, told first-hand.	STAGE
8:05 · 25'	Recognition: partners and Chapter teams Named with citations; Chapter teams called up as teams.	STAGE RECOGNITION
8:30 · 25'	Break on the floor Coffee, the gallery again, conversations. The one thing 2024 asked for most.	FLOOR
8:55 · 30'	Keynote dialogue Two chairs, a member moderating, questions gathered from members beforehand.	STAGE
9:25 · 20'	The Council: recognition, the honor, and 2027 Outgoing members recognized, the peer-nominated honor, then the direction for next year and the one commitment being asked of members.	STAGE RECOGNITION
9:45 · 45'	Dinner and open networking Contributor names on screen throughout.	FLOOR
10:30 p.m.	Ends	

The keynote

No name yet — that is the Council's to nominate. The criteria matter more than the shortlist: someone whose work members already follow, who can speak to what a network like SLS makes possible rather than to their own career, and who will be *interviewed* rather than deliver a speech. In 2024 members asked specifically for shorter, more inspiring speaking and for leaders sharing experience over general advice.

A Vision 2030 delivery leader — someone who has actually shipped a national program, interviewed by a member working on something adjacent. Closest to the theme; my recommendation.

A global voice on a subject the membership is already discussing. Strongest draw, weakest link to the society.

A member of the society whose year stands out. Cheapest and most on-theme, least external pull.

Booking at this level needs eight to ten weeks, so the shortlist should close with the planning phase on November 19.

07
Budget

Indicative range

Built bottom-up for a 300-guest evening with a stage, a gallery build and dinner. This is a planning range, not a quote.

CHARTER SUB-CATEGORY	PRE - VAT RANGE
Logistics — venue, build, stage, AV, F&B, signage	SAR 380,000 – 620,000
Events management — agency fee	SAR 80,000 – 130,000
Program delivery and content — stories, scripts, speakers, translation, recognition	SAR 140,000 – 250,000
Indicative total — roughly SAR 2,000–3,300 a guest	SAR 600,000 – 1,000,000

The right anchor is the 2024 actuals, which EMU holds. Those should replace this range before the charter goes for approval — the charter still reads TBC deliberately.

08
What we need

And by when

- ☐ **This month.** Collection request out to Chapter leads and the Council — achievements and recognition citations, one form. Nothing on stage can be written until this lands.
- ☐ **This month.** Site survey at City Hub: does a stage, a seated 300, a gallery and dinner work in one evening there?
- ☐ **Confirm** December 12 against the Council diary and the venue.
- ☐ **Tell me** whether SLS already has named recognition categories. This note assumes not and proposes the structure from scratch.
- ☐ **Council to nominate** the keynote shortlist, and to confirm it will state a specific 2027 ask from the stage.
- ☐ **Agree** who signs the letter home, and to whom it goes.
- ☐ **By November 19:** achievements in, keynote confirmed, budget replaced with EMU's benchmark.

Companion to the **SLS Annual Assembly 2026 event charter**, in draft and pending approval. Benchmarks are from the 2024 post-event report (468 registrants, 320 attendees, 76.8% overall satisfaction, agenda flow 69.8%). Venue capacity, layout and prayer times to be confirmed on site.